

## Items for Discussion at President's Council

### Notes from September Agenda of FC

First, I want to begin with gratitude and hope (some comments on that)

Second, it is unclear how this council will function. I suspect most faculty are unsure what role/function the President's Council has. My own understanding is that this is mainly a listening session on the part of the Cabinet and on the part of the representatives (e.g., faculty listening to staff, etc.). Some ideas for clarifying the role of the President's Council are as follows:

- Posting a report of the meeting to the landing page
- Sending a report of the meeting to the schools
- Inviting schools to have a President's Council agenda item in which schools can raise issues for representatives to present to the President's Council
- Inviting faculty to send items to the FC support person to be added to the list for discussion at President's Council

Third, one item that is clearly important to the faculty is trust. Faculty desire transparency. The Faculty Committee would like the faculty members appointed to the President's Council to help with this by addressing these questions:

- How does Asbury define transparency?
- How will we know when we have encountered transparency? (there are a variety of narratives that swirl around decisions; there is suspicion; and there are other barriers to knowing if any particular narrative is "transparent").
- How do we distinguish between times when transparency is needed and times when confidentiality is appropriate?

Fourth, does the structure of Asbury lend itself to working cooperatively? Does the organizational structure of the seminary help us to provide a seamless environment for the two major necessities of an academic institution – providing degree programs and having students enrolled in those programs? If the current structures of the seminary lend themselves to competition rather than cooperation, what changes should be made?

Chris:

What is shared governance and what is legitimate to expect?

Are there times for legitimate unilateral decision making? (some background to this question)

Commend: "In The Loop" – so good and much more informative than in the past